Motorola's betting big on the Signature 27

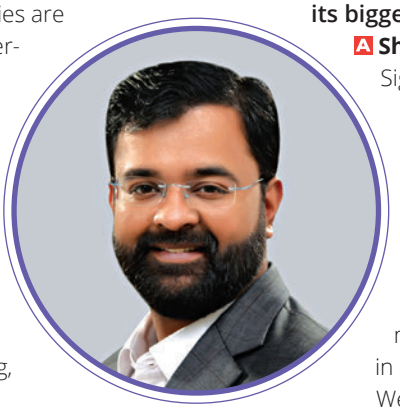
And Qualcomm's new Snapdragon chip is at the heart of it

Aman Rashid | editor@digit.in

Motorola is all set to take its biggest leap in the premium smartphone segment with the Signature 27, and Qualcomm's latest flagship Snapdragon processor is at the centre of that effort. At IMC 2026, I spoke with Saurabh Arora, Head of Mobile, Compute and XR Business at Qualcomm, and Shivam Ranjan, Head of Marketing, APAC at Motorola, about what the two companies are working on. The conversation offered a detailed insight into the Snapdragon 8 Elite Extreme Gen 6 chipset and the Motorola Signature 27, covering performance, on-device AI, camera improvements, cooling, and design.



Saurabh Arora
Head of Mobile, Compute and XR Business at Qualcomm



Shivam Ranjan
Head of Marketing, APAC at Motorola

Q The Motorola Signature 27 is powered by Qualcomm's Snapdragon 8 Elite Extreme Gen 6 processor. What are the biggest improvements users can expect compared to the previous gen?

A Saurabh Arora: The Snapdragon 8 Elite Extreme Gen 6 brings together all the new features, innovations, and technologies we have developed and packed into the chipset. We haven't limited ourselves to just one part of the chipset. We have introduced innovations and improvements across the CPU, GPU, NPU, and ISP, along with the image processing capabilities needed to support new-age agentic AI use cases.

Q What makes the Signature 27 different among competing flagships, and what is its biggest strength?

A Shivam Ranjan: The Signature 27 is the best smartphone we have ever made. That is a big statement for a company like Motorola, because we invented the mobile phone in 1973.

We were also pioneers in innovation during the first journey to the Moon. The words 'one small step for a man, one giant leap for mankind' were transmitted using Motorola technology in 1969. Today, we are saying that the Signature 27 represents a leap of a similar scale in terms of technology. There isn't just one thing I can point to, but the heart of the phone is definitely the Snapdragon chip. As Saurabh said, it is not just about performance or gaming. It is about connectivity and camera, supported by the ISP.

Q AI is becoming a bigger part of smartphones. What are some useful things this new processor can do directly on the phone?

A Saurabh Arora: Everybody is trying to figure out what AI does, but things will change from the perspective of agentic AI use cases.

Earlier, you would ask questions, and receive a response. Going forward, with the ultra-low-power island sensing hub in this chip, the phone can become contextually aware of where you are, what you are thinking, your relationships, and what you might want to do next. That is the kind of proactive assistance agentic AI will bring.

Q What improvements have you made to the cameras, especially when it comes to taking photos and recording videos?

A Shivam Ranjan: The phone comes with an impressive camera setup, a 50-megapixel Sony LYT-910 sensor and a 200-megapixel periscope camera. The combination of this hardware with the Snapdragon chipset, its enhanced ISP, and the NPU allows us to do more with image processing. The phone can start sensing, monitoring, and observing a scene before you take a shot, and then optimise the image.

The device features an AI Video Enhancement Engine, which is activated when someone records a video. It uses the Snapdragon chipset's ISP and NPU to understand the scene and optimise the video in real time, helping deliver the best possible output.

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